CHOCOLATE CHESS PIE

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
1 pie, 23 cm, 8 to 12 servings	**20 min**	**4 to 6 h refrigerated before serving**	**6 to 8 h**

OVEN
350F for 1 h

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Flaky tart dough, partially baked and cooled in a 23 cm pie pan
60 g	Unsalted butter
70 g	Dark chocolate, coarsely chopped
2	Eggs, large
160 ml	Evaporated milk
1 tbsp	Vanilla extract
350 g	Sugar
50 g	Cocoa powder
1/2 tsp	Salt

METHOD

1. Make the flaky tart dough, line a 23 cm pie pan with it, and bake the shell only partway. Cool it before filling.
2. Heat the oven to 350F [180C].
3. Pour water about 5 cm deep into a small saucepan and bring it to a gentle simmer over medium-low heat.
4. Set the butter and the chocolate in a small heatproof bowl, one that sits firmly on the pan's rim, and rest it above the water without letting it touch. Stir with a rubber spatula until melted and smooth, then lift it off the heat.
5. Whisk the eggs, evaporated milk and vanilla into the melted chocolate and butter.
6. Whisk the sugar, cocoa powder and salt together in a medium bowl.
7. Add the chocolate mixture to the dry mixture and whisk until smooth.
8. Pour the batter into the shell and bake about 1 hour, until a paring knife pushed into the middle of the pie comes out clean.
9. Move the pie to a wire rack to cool, then refrigerate it 4 to 6 hours before cutting.

NOTES

A chess pie sets on eggs, butter and sugar alone, with no starch and no fruit, which makes it both sweeter and firmer than a pudding pie. It is sturdy enough to travel.
The shell goes in partially baked, not fully baked, since the filling takes a full hour in the oven.
Any partially baked pie dough works under this filling. The book matches it with the einkorn version of the flaky tart dough.
The 4 to 6 hours in the fridge are part of the recipe, not a resting courtesy. Cut it warm and the filling smears.
Well wrapped, it keeps a week in the fridge. Unsweetened whipped cream is the usual accompaniment.

DOUGH
Flaky Tart Dough

Makes: 2 tart or pie shells, 23 or 25 cm, or 12 tartlet shells at 10 cm / Active Time: 25 min / Rest: 2 h chilled minimum or overnight, then 30 min to 1 h once lined / Total Time: 3 h 30 min to 4 h / Oven: 375F / 190C, about 20 min partially baked or 30 min fully baked

INGREDIENTS

1 tsp	Salt
150 ml	Water, very cold
455 g	All-purpose flour
300 g	Unsalted butter, very cold

METHOD

1. Stir the salt into the cold water until it dissolves. Keep the bowl refrigerated until you need it.
2. Cut the butter into 2.5 cm pieces.
3. Using a food processor, weigh the flour into the processor bowl and scatter the butter across the top. Pulse briefly, stopping at coarse crumbs with plenty of butter still at pea size. Pour in the salted water and pulse a few seconds more, until the dough is clumping toward a ball but is still rough and you can see chunks of butter in it.

4. Working by hand, weigh the flour into a mixing bowl and scatter the butter over the top, then cut it in with a pastry blender or two knives to the same coarse crumb, leaving pea-size butter. Drizzle the salted water over and stir with a fork to a shaggy mass, then bring it gently together into a ball. Stop while it is still rough with butter showing.
5. Split the dough in two on a lightly floured bench and pat each half into a disk 2.5 cm thick. Wrap tightly and chill at least 2 hours, or overnight.
6. To line a pan, roll a disk out to 3 mm on a lightly floured surface, working from the middle outward in every direction. Lift the sheet and swing it a quarter turn every few passes, dust underneath whenever it grabs, and move fast so the butter stays cold.
7. For a pie dish, cut a circle 5 cm wider than the dish. For a tart pan with a removable base, cut it 4 cm wider.
8. Fold the round in half or into quarters to carry it, lay it in the pan, settle it into the bottom and up the sides, and press it home gently. Trim it flush with the rim using a sharp knife.
9. In a pie dish you can instead leave a 12 mm overhang, fold it under itself and crimp or flute the edge. The bakery leaves the edge plain.
10. A shell that goes into the oven unbaked only needs refrigerating until you use it, covered with plastic wrap if that is overnight.
11. A shell you intend to blind bake has to be chilled firm to the touch first, 30 minutes to 1 hour. This is what buys you the flakiest crust.
12. Heat the oven to 375F. Line the chilled shell with parchment paper and fill it with pie weights.
13. For a partially baked shell, give it about 20 minutes, until the surface is dry and pale with no damp opaque patches left. Lift a corner of the paper to check. Lift out the weights and paper and return the shell for a few minutes more.
14. Watch the base while it bakes. If it domes up, pierce it with the tip of a knife, keeping the hole small if a very liquid filling is going in.
15. For a fully baked shell, run about 25 minutes under the weights, until the surface is light brown. Take out the weights and paper and bake 5 minutes more, to golden brown.
16. Cool the shells completely on wire racks before filling them.

NOTES

> 455 g flour to 300 g butter to 150 ml water is the 3:2:1 ratio by weight the dough is built on, so it scales up and down directly.
> The pea-size butter is the whole point. Rolled out, the sheet should show faint streaks of butter.
> Chilling before the bake sets pockets of flour and water around each piece of butter. Those pockets survive the oven and give the fork-tender texture.
> For the einkorn version, replace the all-purpose flour with equal parts pastry flour and einkorn flour.
> Tartine also mixes this dough by a longer method that comes out closer to rough puff. That version is the one used for galettes.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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